Why This Problem Demands Action

Plastic pollution remains one of the most pressing environmental challenges facing our planet. Single-use plastics persist in our ecosystems for centuries, suffocating wildlife and contaminating waterways. Yet compostable materials offer a genuine solution—they return safely to the environment within months, breaking down naturally without toxic residue.

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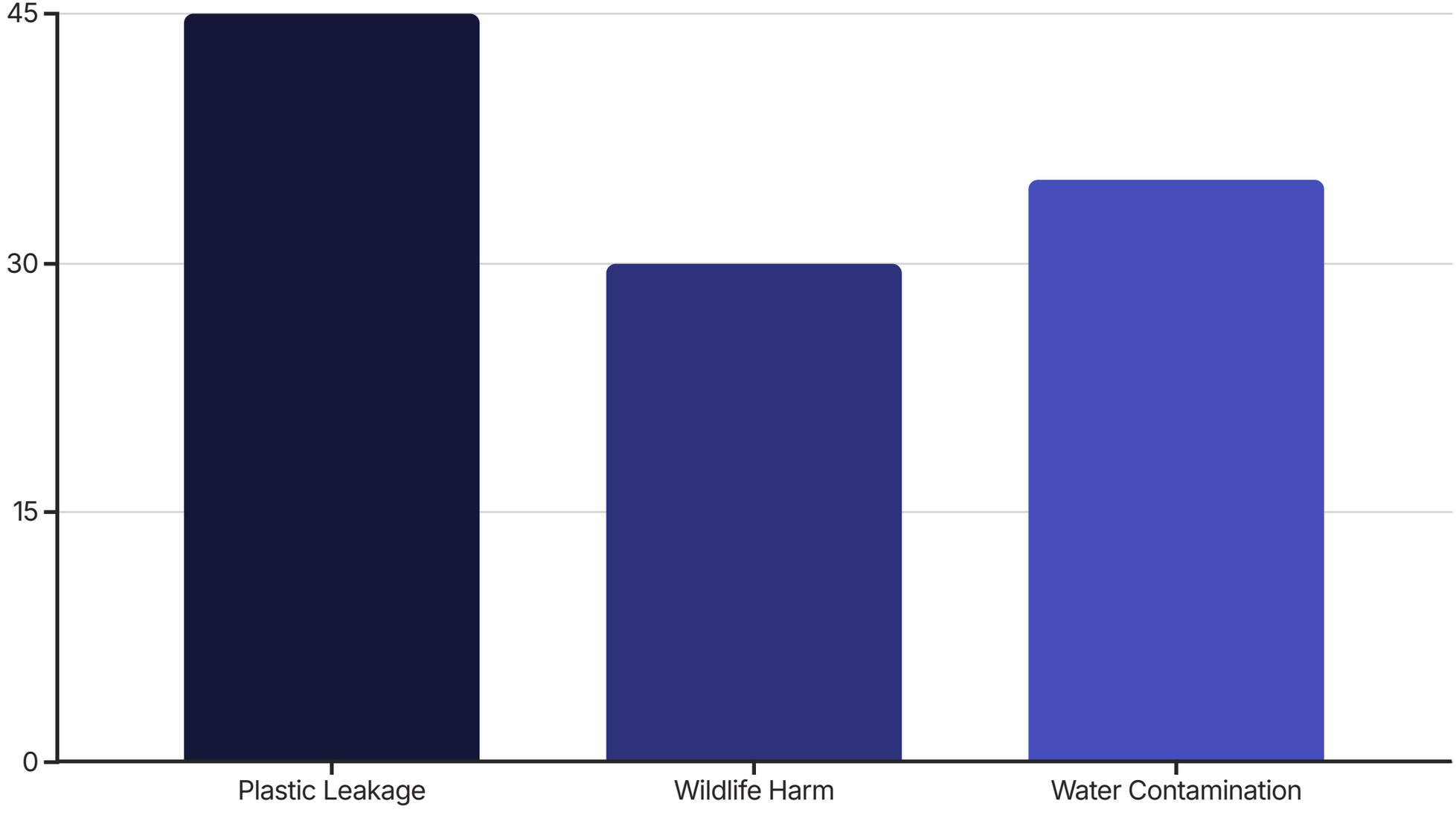
When We Switch, Results Follow

The science is compelling. Research demonstrates that transitioning to certified compostable materials delivers measurable environmental benefits:



A 25% replacement of single-use plastics with certified compostables reduces pollution by nearly half (EPA 2023; *Environmental Science & Technology* 2023; WWF 2023). Compostables decompose completely within 60–90 days, returning nutrients to soil and eliminating persistent microplastic contamination.

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The Evidence Is Undeniable

> **A 2023 study in *Environmental Science & Technology* found that replacing just 25% of single-use plastics with certified compostables reduced plastic pollution in waterways by up to 45%.**

This is not opinion—it is evidence. Our campus has the opportunity to join a growing movement of institutions leading the shift toward circularity. When universities commit to compostable alternatives, we demonstrate to our students, staff, and broader community that sustainability is both scientifically proven and achievable.

Urgent call: If 25% of change delivers 45% pollution reduction, imagine the transformative impact of a campus-wide commitment.

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References & Evidence Base

Research Sources (APA Style)

- United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP). (2024). *Global Plastic Pollution Report 2024*.
- U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). (2023). *Plastics and Decomposition Rates*.
- *Environmental Science & Technology*. (2023). *Evaluating the Environmental Impact of Compostable Substitutions*.
- World Wildlife Fund (WWF). (2023). *Plastics and Wildlife: Global Update 2023*.

All figures cited in this presentation are drawn from peer-reviewed research and official government sources. The evidence supporting compostable alternatives is robust, recent, and actionable. This presentation provides university leadership with the data needed to make informed, evidence-driven sustainability decisions.

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Thank You & Questions

We appreciate your time and attention to our presentation on sustainable initiatives. We are happy to answer any questions you may have.

Group Members

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